The Birthday

Posted originally on the Archive of Our Own at http://archiveofourown.org/works/63571690.

Rating:	General Audiences
Archive Warning:	No Archive Warnings Apply
Category:	F/F
Fandom:	She-Ra and the Princesses of Power (2018)
Relationship:	Castaspella/Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra)
Characters:	Castaspella (She-Ra), Shadow Weaver | Light Spinner (She-Ra), Original Child Character(s)
Additional Tags:	b-day themed, Alternate Universe - Modern Setting, Kinda Fluffy, Domestic, Double Drabble, two of them again
Language:	English
Series:	Part 4 of Series of Castaweaver double-drabbles
Stats:	Published: 2025-03-04 Words: 400 Chapters: 2/2

The Birthday

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Summary

It's Arxia's eighth birthday… and she's not thrilled about it.

Notes

Note, in case it's not obvious: Arxia calls Casta "Mom" and SW "Mother" for obvious reasons.

See the end of the work for more notes

Part 1

It was her special day.

Kids normally love their birthdays, no?

Well, Arxia apparently didn't.

Her eighth birthday…

She recalled the previous year and it had been a nice day! Her mom made sure to fit everything Arxia wanted to do in the day, bought her whatever food and treats she wanted… She even got a gift from her mother!

But, for some reason, the past few years she recalled didn't make her feel excited about it.

On the contrary, she was quite melancholic for a kid her age.

She only recalled since her fifth birthday, something told her the previous four years weren't really relevant, and she felt no joy from those memories.

—What's wrong, Kid?

—Mo-Mother— she stammered, surprised by Shadow Weaver. —Nothing, nothing.

—Sure— the woman scoffed. —I'm not that easy to fool. Talk.

—I… don't feel like celebrating— she shyly admitted.

—I see— she smirked, before sitting next to her. —That's pretty normal, Child. Maybe our species genetically dislikes birthdays…

—You… don't like them either?

—No.

—But Mom loves them— she pointed out, dispirited.

—She loves *you* more and won't force you to do anything you don't want… So let's go talk to her — she offered.

Part 2

Chapter Notes

See the end of the chapter for notes

—You- Ah… You don’t want to celebrate?— Castaspella asked, concerned. —Si-since when!?

—I don’t know…— Arxia admitted, looking away.

—What about last year? O-or the year before!? You didn’t… want to do anything?

—I-I just don’t- I’m not excited about it, Mom— the girl stammered, twitching her hands nervously.

—Why didn’t you tell me before?— she asked, kneeling to Arxia’s height. She briefly gazed at Shadow Weaver, who stood a few meters away, just looking, and added —Is it because of me?

Her concern only grew as her daughter nodded, looking at the ground.

—Sorry, Mom.

—Oh, my Baby— Castaspella let out, embracing Arxia. —I wouldn’t be mad… you should have told me— she assured her. —I wanted you to enjoy your day; would have *never* forced you to do it if you refused— she insisted.

—I didn’t want to upset you— the girl sobbed, hugging her mom back. —I liked going out, but I don’t like my birthday.

—Why’s that?— she gently asked, releasing her.

—I don’t know. Mother says it’s a thing of our species.

—Really?

—Possibly— Shadow Weaver confirmed. —None of us celebrates…

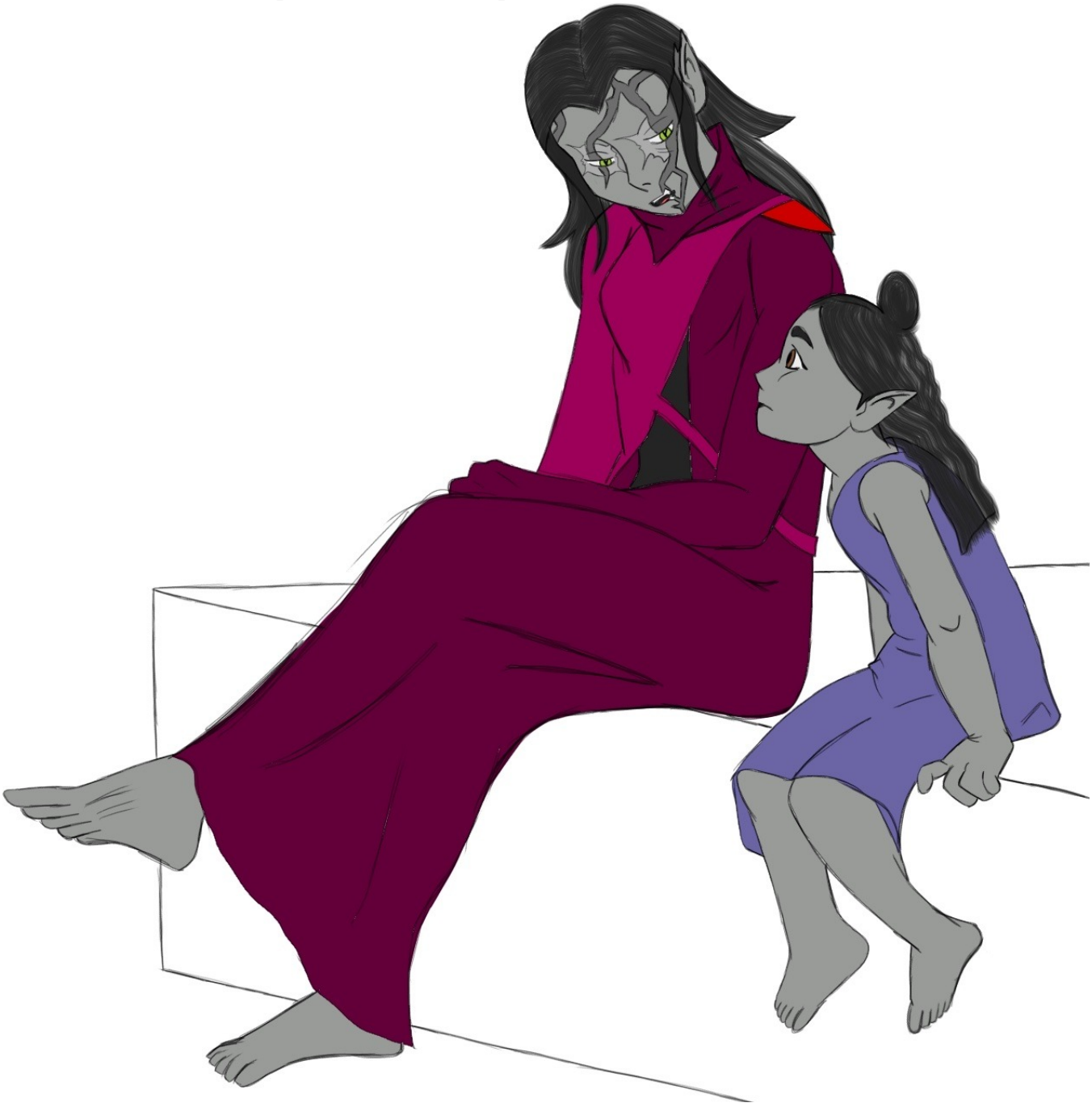
—Oh, that’s… it’s fine— she nodded. —Today is just another day, then— she smiled.

Chapter End Notes

The thing about SW's (and Arxia's!) species not liking birthdays is totally SW bullshitting it, btw XD

End Notes

FYI, this one fanart also displayed in The Girl is precisely the moment at the end of Part 1!!



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